

Breath Support — Practice Sheet

Aaron · built from the measured analysis of **Pressure Down** (Captain Cook Tavern, 25 Jul 2026). All exercise text is copied verbatim from the engine's prescription library; the one shaded box at the end is a coaching note and is labelled as such.

Primary limiter	Breath support — severity 49/100
Evidence	49% of phrase endings sag (25 of 51 phrases)
What it sounds like	Notes arrive on pitch, hold about a second, then slide down. Sliding, not breaking.
Where it bites	Worst from 2:44 onward — 2:44 (-1.9 semitones), 3:01 (-2.2), 3:25 (-0.8). Early in the song you slide <i>up</i> into notes instead.
Your cue	“Keep the ribs wide and let the air meter out slowly.”

A 10-minute session

1	Straw Phonation in Water	2 min	warm up — and watch the bubbles stay even
2	Rib Cage Stationary Drill	3 min	names your exact fault: ribs must not collapse
3	Sibilant Hiss	2 min	closest to singing — air actually flowing
4	The 3:01 phrase	3 min	one phrase only, ribs staying wide

Every exercise in this library carries the same transfer rule: **apply the sensation to one short phrase only — do not run the whole song until the cue holds.**

The eight breath-support exercises

1. The Farinelli Maneuver

Target: Suspended Breath Control. · **The one your analysis prescribed first.**

Do this	Inhale for 4 counts, suspend (hold with open glottis) for 4, exhale for 4; increase to 10+ counts.
Should feel	Inhale low and wide, suspend without closing the throat, then release like a slow leak.
Pass / fail	Counts are even and the throat stays open during the suspension.
Stop or reduce intensity if dizziness, shoulder lifting, throat gripping, or breath-holding appears.	

2. Rib Cage Stationary Drill

Target: Thoracic Stability. · **Most direct hit on your fault.**

Do this	Place hands on lower ribs; inhale/exhale while keeping the ribs expanded and the sternum high.
Should feel	Keep the ribs gently open as if the body is staying wide around the sound.
Pass / fail	Ribs do not collapse at the start of the exhale.
Stop or reduce intensity if dizziness, shoulder lifting, throat gripping, or breath-holding appears.	

3. The Sibilant Hiss

Target: Steady Airflow Management. · **Closest to real singing.**

- Do this** Inhale and release a constant [s] sound for as long as possible, aiming for 30-60 seconds.
- Should feel** Let the [s] feel like one thin, steady thread of air.
- Pass / fail** The hiss stays even with no sudden bursts or fading.

Stop or reduce intensity if dizziness, shoulder lifting, throat gripping, or breath-holding appears.

4. Pulsated Fricatives

Target: Abdominal Flexibility.

- Do this** Rapid, rhythmic bursts of [f] or [v] sounds (e.g., in triplets) to engage the abdominal wall.
- Should feel** Let the belly wall bounce lightly without locking the throat.
- Pass / fail** Pulses are even and quick without neck tension.

Stop or reduce intensity if dizziness, shoulder lifting, throat gripping, or breath-holding appears.

5. The Tissue Flutter

Target: Visual Flow Biofeedback.

- Do this** Sustaining a vowel while blowing against a single tissue; a steady angle indicates consistent air pressure.
- Should feel** Keep the tissue angle steady; do not blast it.
- Pass / fail** Tissue movement stays consistent across the vowel.

Stop or reduce intensity if dizziness, shoulder lifting, throat gripping, or breath-holding appears.

6. Back-Breathing Expansion

Target: Posterior Lobe Activation.

- Do this** Place hands on the lower back/kidney area and breathe until expansion is felt against the thumbs.
- Should feel** Feel the lower ribs widen and stay buoyant; throat quiet; shoulders heavy; airflow steady rather than dumped.
- Pass / fail** Airflow stays even for the target count and the body remains expanded without visible neck effort.

Stop or reduce intensity if dizziness, shoulder lifting, throat gripping, or breath-holding appears.

7. Silent Inhalation Drill

Target: Laryngeal Abduction.

- Do this** Rapidly inhaling through an open throat without making noise to ensure full glottal opening.
- Should feel** Breathe as if surprised, but silent — cool air, open back of throat.
- Pass / fail** No audible gasp or shoulder lift.

Stop or reduce intensity if dizziness, shoulder lifting, throat gripping, or breath-holding appears.

8. Axial Alignment Scan

Target: Postural Equilibrium.

- Do this** Standing with feet shoulder-width, knees unlocked, and weight evenly distributed for optimal airflow.
- Should feel** Feel the lower ribs widen and stay buoyant; throat quiet; shoulders heavy; airflow steady rather than dumped.
- Pass / fail** Airflow stays even for the target count and the body remains expanded without visible neck effort.

Stop or reduce intensity if dizziness, shoulder lifting, throat gripping, or breath-holding appears.

Warm-up — Straw Phonation in Water

Target: Water-Resistance Massage. · **Not a breath-support exercise** — it sits in the warm-up/reset set.

Included because it is the only drill here where you make sound while training airflow, and the bubbles show your fault directly.

Do this Phonating into a straw submerged 2-5cm in water; bubbles provide visual/tactile feedback.

Should feel Small even bubbles; water should massage, not fight you.

Pass / fail Bubbles are steady and the voice feels easier afterwards.

Stop if back-pressure becomes throat pressure, bubbles are violent, or the singer coughs/feels squeezed.

How to progress it — coaching note, NOT from the library

Blow for as long as you can **while the bubbles stay even**, keeping the ribs wide, and push that a little further each session.

Measure steady seconds, not total seconds. The moment the bubbles go uneven or you feel the throat take over, the rep is finished — stop there. Chasing maximum duration means squeezing out the last of the air with collapsing ribs, which is exactly the fault you are trying to remove: you would be rehearsing the sag. Steady-bubble seconds is a real progressive measure of the thing that is actually broken, and unlike a 1-semitone sag you can see it happening.

Log the number each session. Next time this song is recorded, check whether the 49% phrase-ending sag has moved.

Safety. Every exercise here shares one stop rule: dizziness, shoulder lifting, throat gripping or breath-holding means stop or ease off. This sheet relays the library your analysis prescribes from and is not a substitute for a teacher watching you do it.